

THE MOVE

Event cue -> light acknowledgement -> interpretation question -> silence -> follow their read. -> That was [brief neutral acknowledgement]. What did you make of it? -> When [event] happened, what was your read on it? -> No need to have a neat ?

START HERE

After they have described an event but before they have interpreted it, ask one clean meaning-making question: "What did you make of it?"

SAY THIS

Quick / default	"What did you make of it?"
Soft / low-pressure	"No need for a polished answer - what is your read so far?"
Social / casual	"That is a strange one. What did you make of it?"
Professional / work	"What is your read on the meeting?"
Digital / text	"What did you make of that message?"
Conflict / repair	"When I said that, what did you make of it?"

AVOID

- They are in acute distress and need support, safety, or action first
- The event is traumatic and the question would feel like a demand to process before they are ready
- You still need basic facts before any interpretation makes sense

REMEMBER

Ask for their read before offering yours.